Austin Perez

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EDUCATION

- **B.S. Computer Science + Mathematics**, Washington University in St. Louis [Completed Dec 2025, Conferred May 2026]
- **M.S. Computer Science (coursework)**, Washington University in St. Louis, GPA 3.93 *(left to join Microsoft)* [2025]

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **AI & Agentic Engineering**: Agentic workflows with SOTA models, model-agnostic LLM pipelines, LLM APIs (Claude, OpenAI, Gemini), GitHub Copilot, LLM-based test generation
- **Languages**: C++, TypeScript/JavaScript, Python, Java, HTML/CSS
- **Frameworks & Libraries**: React, React Native, Node.js/Express, Next.js, FastAPI
- **Cloud & DevOps**: AWS (*EC2, ECS, App Runner, S3*), Docker, Kubernetes, GitHub Actions
- **Databases**: SQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB

WORK EXPERIENCE

- **Software Engineer | Microsoft (Windows, File Explorer)** [Jan 2026 – Present]
  - Shipped the redesigned, **customizable File Explorer context menu** on one of the most-used surfaces in Windows, and drove its rollout from **Windows Insider** channels to **Windows 11 retail**.
  - Cut **context menu load time** in half, from **400 ms to under 200 ms (P50)**, addressing long-standing feedback that the menu was slow and cluttered and driving down customer dissatisfaction (DSAT).
  - Ported legacy context menu verbs (e.g., Send To) to the modern menu in **days rather than weeks** by using **agentic workflows** to reimplement legacy code as modern code.
  - Early adopter of agentic engineering on the team: taught teammates **cost-efficient AI usage** and model selection, and recognized for steering agents toward correct, maintainable solutions.
- **Founding Engineer | SPARC Sports** [May 2025 – Present, part-time since Jan 2026]
  - Founding engineer on SPARC, an AI-powered mental performance platform for competitive tennis used by **30 teams and 400 athletes**, from high school programs to **NCAA Division I**.
  - Built the entire product end to end: iOS/Android apps, coach analytics dashboard, and cloud backend, using **TypeScript/React**, **Node**, **Postgres**, and **AWS App Runner/ECS**.
  - Architected a **provider-agnostic LLM pipeline** (in production on GPT-6 Luna) that maps athlete journal entries to a **psychologist-reviewed library** of techniques, exercises, and modules, grounding every AI recommendation in vetted content.
  - **Mentored 4 interns** for 1+ year, guiding side projects shipped in the app; introduced AI-assisted coding & test tools to speed delivery.
- **Founder & Product Manager | Quture** [Feb 2024 – Aug 2025]
  - Founded and launched Quture, a Gen Z secondhand clothing marketplace, built with **TypeScript**, **React Native**, and the **MERN** stack.
  - Built a **virtual try-on closet** using **computer vision** and **AI image editing** to turn clothing listings into try-on-ready garments.
  - Recruited and led a team of **6 developers**; raised **$15,000+** and reached the finals of multiple startup competitions.

PROJECTS

- **MineZero | Minecraft Mod, 111K+ Downloads** [2025 – Present]
  - Built and maintain an **open-source** (GitHub, Apache 2.0) **Java** mod, grown to **111K+ downloads** on CurseForge.
  - Manage the player community on **Discord** and CurseForge, turning feedback and bug reports into iterative releases with new multiplayer modes and configurable gamerules.
  - Supports **Forge** and **NeoForge** across Minecraft 1.12.2, 1.20.1, and 1.21.1; localized in 9 languages.

RELEVANT COURSES

- **Large Language Models (Grad) | Systems Security (Grad) | Data Management at Scale (Grad) | AI for Health (Grad) | Artificial Intelligence | Programming Systems & Languages | Data Structures & Algorithms | Software Engineering Workshop | Probability & Statistics | Matrix Algebra**